

Dear Parent/Guardian,

We would like to inform you of an upcoming instructional unit your student will participate in during Career Exploration/Social-Emotional Learning time. This unit is designed to support students in understanding social influences, adolescent decision-making, and substance prevention through age-appropriate discussions and activities.

Throughout the unit, students will explore how influences such as peers, media, stress, and personal goals can impact choices and overall well-being. The curriculum also emphasizes critical thinking, resilience, communication skills, and future readiness.

Below is a weekly overview of the unit:

- **Week 1:** Why This Matters
- **Week 2:** Teen Brain & Decision Making
- **Week 3:** Substance Categories & Effects
- **Week 4:** Media & Peer Influence
- **Week 5:** Refusal Skills
- **Week 6:** Stress & Coping
- **Week 7:** Real Stories & Case Studies
- **Week 8:** Help-Seeking & Resources
- **Week 9:** Career Readiness & Future Goals
- **Week 10:** Reading Critically
- **Week 11:** Argumentative Writing I
- **Week 12:** Argumentative Writing II
- **Week 13:** Decision-Making Scenarios
- **Week 14:** Recovery & Resilience
- **Week 15:** PSA Creation
- **Week 16:** Future Readiness Reflection

Our goal is to provide students with opportunities to reflect, build healthy coping and decision-making skills, and develop strategies that support positive choices both now and in the future.

If you would prefer for your student to opt out of this unit, an alternative learning environment will be available. Please contact the school counselors to discuss this option.

Thank you for your continued partnership and support.